

9th Sep, 2026

Ethics & Social Responsibility

Lecture Four.

Noemi Chaw



‘lesson plan’

one

**Group
Presentation**

two

**Case
Studies**

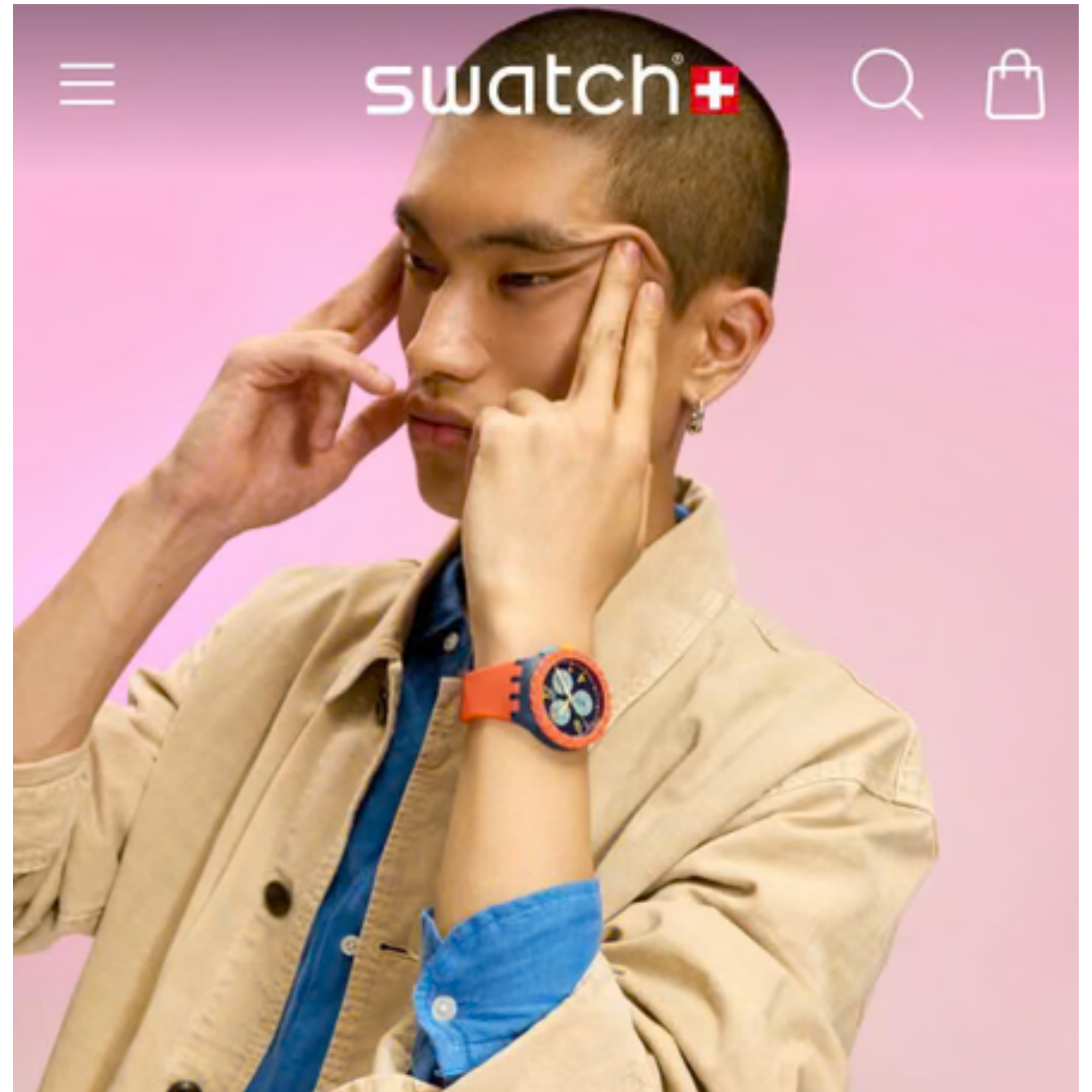
GROUP PRESENTATION

and q&a.

CASE STUDIES

one. was swatch being racist?

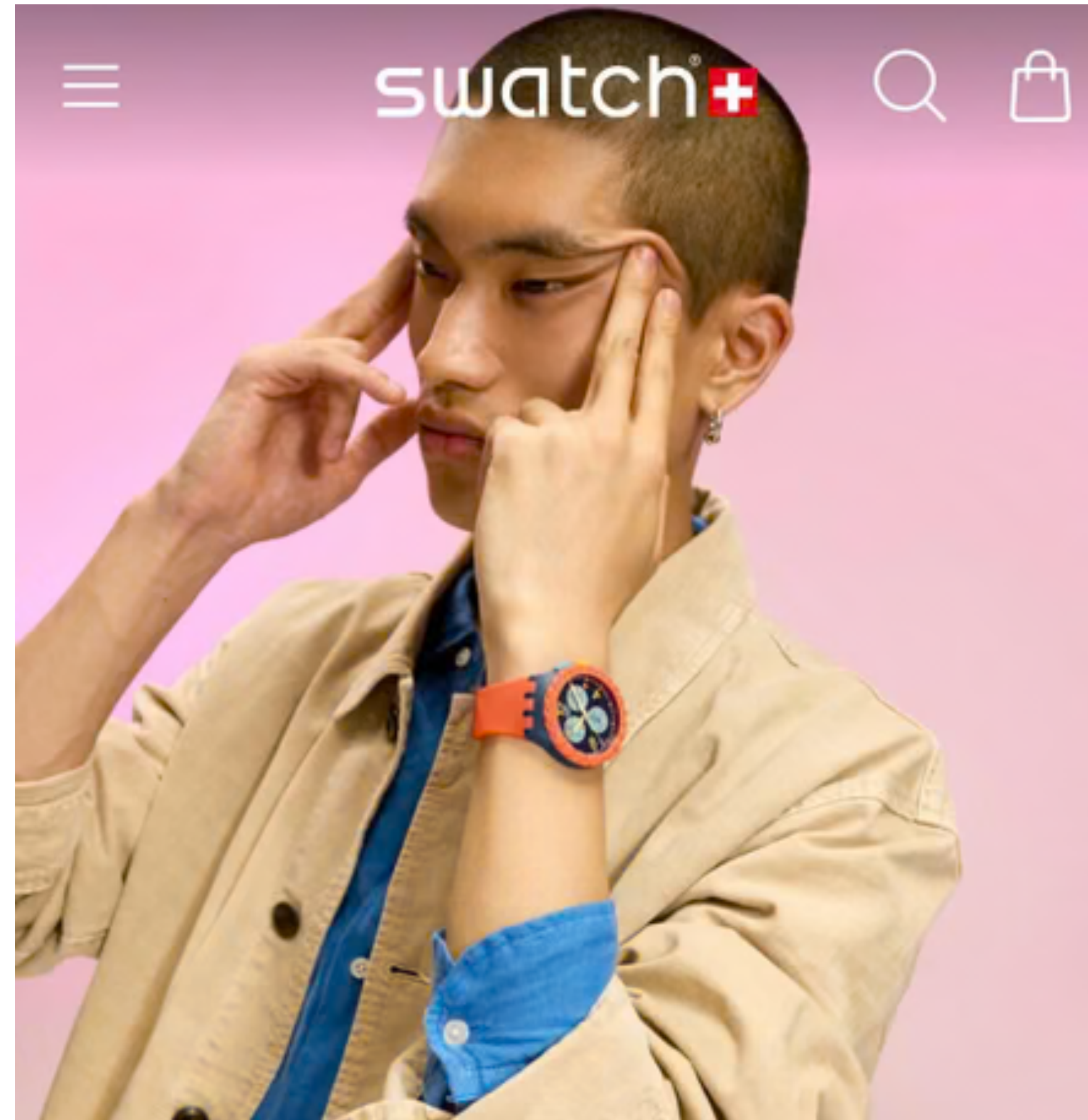
let's
look
at
the
ad



what's wrong with this image?

what about the ad?

So,
Do you think that this
ad was ethical?



**model striking a racist
pose**

**Impact on Swatch's
Sales?**

China, Hong Kong,
and Macau account
for approximately 27%
of Swatch's revenue.

what did swatch say?

We have taken note of the recent concerns regarding the portrayal of a model in images for the Swatch ESSENTIALS Collection.

We treat this matter with the utmost importance and have immediately removed all related materials worldwide.

We sincerely apologize for any distress or misunderstanding this may have caused.



swatch  • [Follow](#)



jerabraham  How does an ad like this even get approved in 2025? This is what happens when you hire creative agencies and marketers with zero cultural fluency.

2w 144 likes Reply ...

— View replies (2)



yantastic  "Concerns" "MAY have caused" lol I just know a WHITE creative director made the model do it and a WHITE manager



3,587 likes

August 16

what did swatch say?

We have taken note of the recent concerns regarding the portrayal of a model in images for the Swatch ESSENTIALS Collection.

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We sincerely apologize for any distress or misunderstanding this may have caused.

So,

Do you think that this response was ethical?

CASE STUDIES

two. that sydney sweeney ad.

for the uninitiated,
let's look at the ad



Video Advertisement

for the uninitiated,
let's look at the ad

So,
Do you think
that this ad was
ethical?



what did american eagle say?



Are You
satisfied with this
response?

does your answer change if you see this?



So,

Did American Eagle
act ethically?

CASE STUDIES

three. that gap ad.

another denim campaign

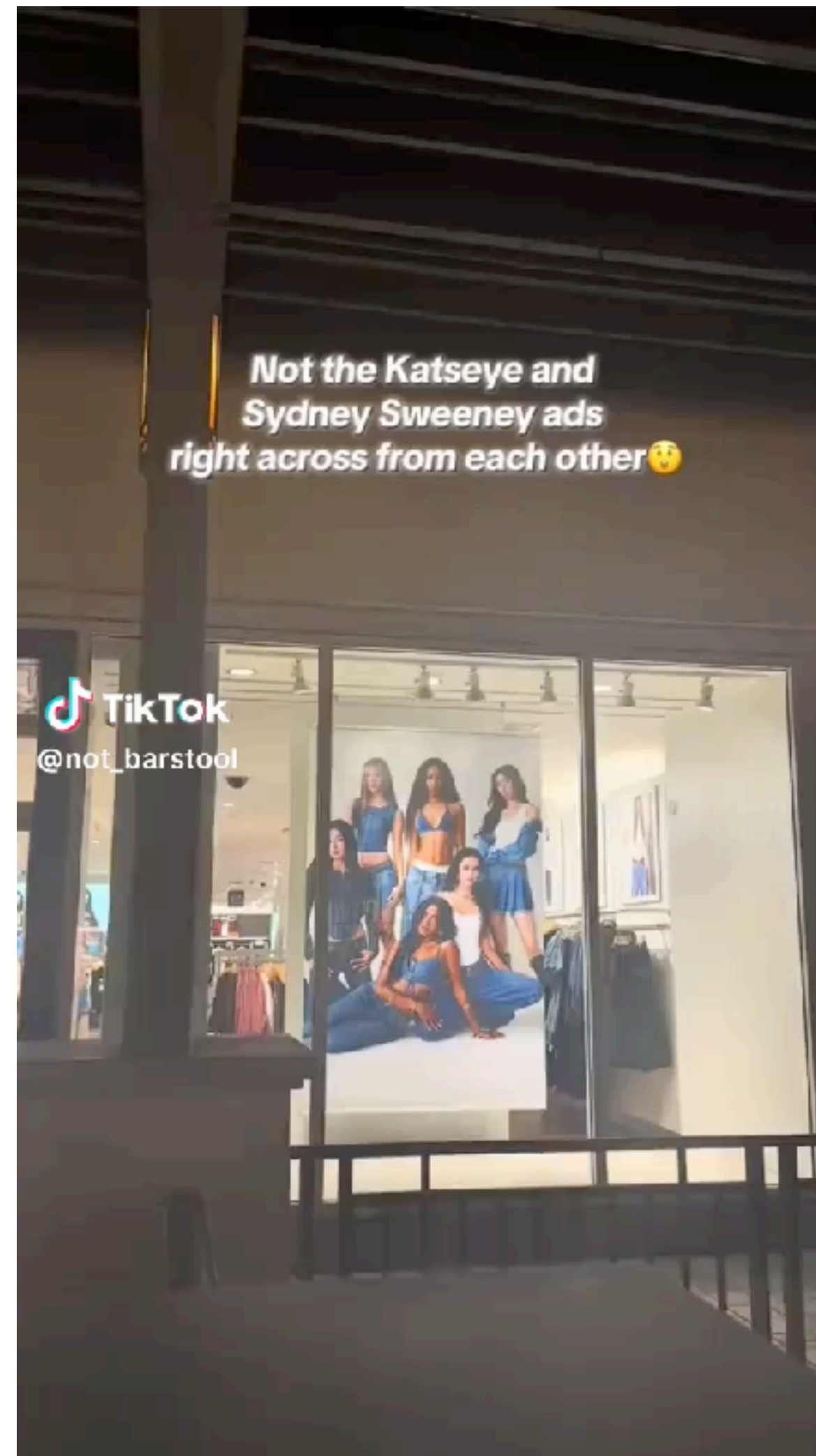


So,
Was this ad
ethical?

Video Advertisement

healthy competition?

So,
Do you think
competition
between
businesses is
ethical?



is competition in business ethical?

Utilitarianism

Who is “everyone” in this context? What are the pleasures generated? What about the pains?

Kantian Ethics

What is the intention behind competition? Can competition be adopted universally? Do you fail to respect others when you compete with them?

Egoism

Did Gap gain more power/dominion through this campaign? What do you think of enforced cooperation and competition?

CASE STUDIES

four. let's talk about rage baiting

“
ragebaiting
”

**Online Content
Designed to
Elicit Rage & Anger
Amongst
Audiences**

Generally Done for the
Purpose of Increasing
Engagement, Reach, &
Support

is ragebaiting ethical?

Kantian Ethics

What is the intention behind ragebaiting? Can ragebaiting be adopted universally? Is it necessarily a failure to respect persons?

Egoism

Can more power be gained through ragebaiting? Does ragebaiting actually promote anarchy? But, was Rand right in this instance?

Aristotle Virtue Ethics

What are some applicable virtues? Could they fall within the mean?

CASE STUDIES

five, air-conditioning that saves the earth?

a quick summary

Let's watch a video summarising the incident

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IpMBiv8DElw>

a little nitty gritty

The Problematic Claim:

Using Prism+ air-conditioners is the “best tip” to “save [the] Earth”.

Why?

Advertisements should not mislead in any way by “inaccuracy, ambiguity, exaggeration or omission” and not misrepresentation any matter likely to influence consumers’ attitudes to the product.

In its Defence:

Prism+ claims that the ad was supposed to be “playful and tongue-in-cheek”; and the Earth-saving theme was “satirical humor”. Also, Prism+ maintains that the ad was not misrepresented.

was the ad ethical?

Aristotle's Virtue Ethics

What is the mean in this context? Could the mean shift overtime?

Egoism

Who are the relevant actors involved? Were they all acting in their self-interest?

Which strands of egoism are relevant?

Kantian Ethics

Did Prism+ act with good intentions? Can false-advertising ever be universalizable?

Was there a lack of respect for persons?

CASE STUDIES

six, zero calories? really, iTea?

this was the ad

The Claim:

This ad appeared to claim that these drinks are zero-sugar and zero-calories.

The Impact:

Consumers were apparently baffled and confused by seemingly contradictory claim

The Truth:

iTea was supposedly referring to its new sugar substitute, which contained zero calories.



was the ad ethical?

Kantian Ethics

Was this ad good-intentioned? Even if so, can misleading advertisements be universalized?

Egoism

The Singapore Food Agency and Health Promotion Board considered taking action against iTea. Is this a matter of Machiavelli Egoism?

Utilitarianism

False and misleading ads are a violation of s 17 of the Sale of Food Act. Is such legislation ethical from the utilitarian perspective?

CASE STUDIES

seven, do you watch HBO?

ethical consulting practice?



\$37m

Charged by McKinsey for advise to change HBO to HBO Max to Max to HBO Max.

ethical consulting practice?

2022 McKinsey charged Warner Brothers \$55m to merge with Discovery.

**2022
to
2025** McKinsey charged Warner Brothers \$\$37m to change HBO's streaming service name.

2025 McKinsey charged Warner Brothers \$63m to split Warner Brothers and Discovery into two separate entities.

was this ethical consulting?

Kantian Ethics

if you make an assumption as to McKinsey's intention, what would a reasonable intention be?

Egoism

Did McKinsey gain power through this incident?

Aristotle Virtue Ethics

What are some applicable virtues? Could they fall within the mean?

what about hbo's actions?

Kantian Ethics

In changing the name of their app so frequently, has HBO respected their consumers and stakeholders?

Egoism

In heeding McKinsey's advice, did HBO gain or lose power? Were they actually acting in their own self-interest?

Aristotle Virtue Ethics

What are some applicable virtues? Could they fall within the mean?

CASE STUDIES

eight, "dark patterns"

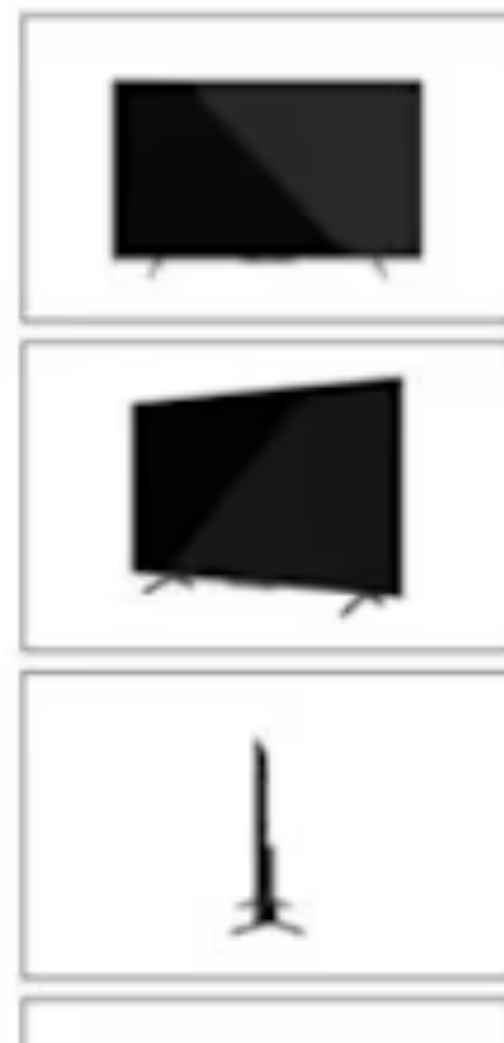
ethical marketing practice?

“In Stock: Running Low!”

Stack up to \$1,000 worth of in-store vouchers | Ends in 5d 6h 35m 9s

PRISM+ [Extra \\$300 off with Climate Voucher](#) TV Air Conditioners Smart Locks **NEW** Fridges **NEW** Air Purifiers Ceiling Fans Monitors Soundbars Accessories Support 

[TECH SPECS](#) [BUY NOW](#)



PRISM+ Q55 Ultra

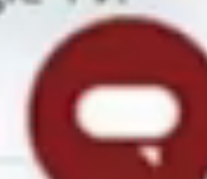
★★★★★ (4.9) 1449 reviews **In Stock: Running Low!** 

\$1,299  **\$999** 

~~\$1,999~~ Up to 67% Off! 

4x \$325 w/ **Grob**  or 3x \$433 w/ **atome** **A** 

Presenting Q-Ultra series, featuring QLED technology. Dolby Atmos, Dolby vision, HDR10+  PRISM+ Support and more. Our top of line QLED series with Google TV. It's where price meets performance.



Thank
You.

“

Where do you buy
your jeans?

—